

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI): 1Q26 First Take: Inline with weak PPOP offset by lower credit cost

UOB posted **1Q26 net profit of S\$1,437mn, -4% yoy/+2% qoq, +0% vs. GSe.**

Results this quarter were supported by **lower credit cost of 23bps vs GSe's 34bps** with SPs at 29bps and a reversal of GPs of -3bps. NPAs fell 3% qoq on lower NPA in ASEAN, SG and ROW (US NPLs fell to 1.5% vs 3% in 4Q) with Greater China NPAs up 15% qoq at S\$232m. New NPAs were lower qoq back to more normal levels at S\$341m with upgrades, recoveries and write-offs at S\$461m this quarter. GP coverage on performing loans including RLAR stayed steady at 1.0%. However, **PPOP disappointed -5% vs GSe (-9% yoy/8% qoq) with (1) Non NII -13% vs GSe, -12%yoy/+6%qoq, as fee income -16% GSe, -8% yoy/+2%qoq**, on better loan related fees and wealth fees though the latter growth was weak at +8%qoq/3%yoy with net new money was S\$1bn in 1Q26 vs S\$2bn in 4Q25 and S\$5bn/S\$2bn for 3Q25/1Q25. AUM is down -1.5% qoq on lower deposits and lower invested assets. **Other non-NII -9% vs GSe -17% qoq/+44%qoq, (2) NII came in inline** at -4% qoq with NIM 2bps lower at 1.82% due to lower hibor but offset with deposit repricing in SG with loans yields 1bps and loan growth of 0.5%qoq. (3) **Cost was well controlled** with CIR at 44.5%.

UOB largely maintains 2026 guidance, (1) Loan growth to be low single digit (GSe of 2%), (2) FY NIM guidance of 1.75% - 1.80% (GSe NIM 1.73%), (3) Fee growth of high single digit (GSe 9%); (4) Credit cost to be between 25-30bps (GSe at 32bps); (5) Low single digit operating expenses (GSe of 1.5%).

Overall, while net income was inline and CoC was better than expected. PPOP was disappointing -9% yoy much lower than peers driven by weak non-NII generation vs peers with much lower wealth fee growth and weak NNM generation. Deposit growth was also slightly disappointing flat qoq/ +6%yoy again weaker than peers which will allow for lower NII support going forward. All in, we view this as a weak set of results, while asset quality looks better, PPOP generation is weak which will still be a drag to bottom line. UOB is holding a media briefing at 9.00am local time, followed by an analyst briefing at 10.15am.

Key highlights:

- **Net interest income was in-line with GSe, -1% qoq/-4% yoy** with qoq NII slight moderation mainly due to the shorter quarter. Loan growth was modest at ~flat qoq /+4% yoy. The qoq growth was flat as growth in Greater China was offset by slight decline in Singapore and rest of the world.

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- **NIM declined 2bps qoq to 1.82%, modestly above GSe**, mainly driven by continued margin pressure from lower benchmark rates, partially mitigated by disciplined funding cost management and optimisation of deposit mix. LDR remained stable at 82.9%.
- **Non-interest income was below GSe, +16% qoq/ -12% yoy**. Fees and commission gross income increased 2% qoq, supported by higher loan related fees and higher wealth fees of +8%qoq/3%yoy, partly offset by normalisation of card fees from the prior quarter's seasonal high. Other non-interest income increased 45% qoq driven by stronger customer treasury income and improved trading and liquidity management activities amid market volatility.
- **NPL ratio remained stable at 1.50%**, as lower new NPL formation of S\$341m was more than offset by upgrades, recoveries and write-offs of S\$461m in 1Q26. NPAs fell 3% qoq on lower NPA in ASEAN, SG and ROW (US NPLs fell to 1.5% vs 3% in 4Q) with Greater China NPAs up 15% qoq at S\$232m.
- **Credit cost in total remained contained at 23bps and came under GSe on our calculation**, with CoC on loans at 29bps. NPA coverage improved to 100% from 97% in 4Q25 and unsecured NPA coverage increased to 272% from 254% in 4Q25. GP coverage on performing loans including RLAR remained stable at ~1.0%.
- **Expenses were below GSe, flat qoq/-2% yoy**, with cost-to-income ratio (CIR) improving to 44.5% from 46.4% in 4Q25, supported by continued cost discipline alongside ongoing investments in strategic initiatives.

We are Neutral rated on UOB. Our 12-month 2-stage DDM-based target price is **S\$41.50**. Downside risks: Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed cut cycle. Changes in strategy to return capital. Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

Exhibit 1: 1Q26 earnings summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q26E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Net Interest Income	2,409	2,336	2,265	2,345	2,324	(4)	(1)	2,327	(0)
Fee & Commission	694	636	615	624	637	(8)	2	756	(16)
Other Non-Interest Income	554	493	518	320	462	(17)	44	506	(9)
Non-Interest Income	1,248	1,129	1,133	944	1,099	(12)	16	1,262	(13)
Operating Income	3,657	3,465	3,398	3,289	3,422	(6)	4	3,589	(5)
Operating Expenses	(1,559)	(1,536)	(1,535)	(1,528)	(1,523)	(2)	(0)	(1,582)	(4)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,098	1,929	1,863	1,761	1,899	(9)	8	2,007	(5)
Loan Loss Provisions	(290)	(279)	(1,361)	(113)	(203)	(30)	80	(300)	(32)
Pre-tax Profit	1,822	1,638	520	1,676	1,712	(6)	2	1,729	(1)
Net Profit	1,490	1,338	443	1,410	1,437	(4)	2	1,431	0

Balance sheet (\$\$mn)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q26E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Assets	538,009	537,838	555,419	572,061	574,233	7	0	579,591	(1)
Gross Loans	341,154	342,900	351,084	352,180	353,837	3.7	0.5	354,169	(0)
Non-Performing Loans	5,458	5,341	5,617	5,379	5,308	(3)	(1)	5,524	(4)
Customer Deposits	401,250	405,076	419,660	425,938	426,731	6	0	432,391	(1)

CAMEL Ratios (%)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	YoY %	QoQ %	1Q26E	Actual vs. Est (%)
Core Tier 1	15.4	15.1	14.5	14.9	15.2			15.2	
NPL Ratio	1.60	1.56	1.60	1.53	1.50			1.56	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	34	33	157	13	23			34	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.00	1.91	1.82	1.84	1.82			1.79	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	42.6	44.3	45.2	46.5	44.5			44.1	
Loan-to-Deposits	85.0	84.7	83.7	82.7	82.9			81.9	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

UOBH.SI	12m Price Target: S\$41.50	Price: S\$36.65	Upside: 13.2%			
Neutral	GS Forecast					
	Market cap: S\$61.3bn / \$48.1bn	Net inc. (S\$ mn)	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
	3m ADTV: S\$114.4mn / \$89.8mn	EPS (S\$)	4,681.0	5,434.6	5,824.6	6,123.9
	Singapore	EPS growth (%)	2.73	3.18	3.41	3.59
	Asia Financials	P/E (X)	(22.4)	16.5	7.3	5.2
	M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	13.1	11.5	10.7	10.2
		ROA (%)	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.1
		ROE (%)	0.8	0.9	1.0	1.0
		Price/PPOP (X)	9.6	10.8	11.1	11.1
		Dividend yield (%)	8.0	8.0	7.6	7.3
			4.4	4.5	4.9	5.1
			12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
		EPS (S\$)	0.81	0.85	0.76	0.80

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 6 May 2026 close.

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